Divergences

Economic Issues

Despite regular exchanges of close cooperation between Russia and China, there was some mistrust. Scholar Lo (2010) observed that China's increasing economic clout and a ‘rising China’ made Russia feel more threatened and was true, as some sections of Russian scholars said, a significant threat to Russia. Russia was also concerned about China’s growing involvement in Russia’s ‘near abroad’ affairs. It feared China’s demographic expansion in the Far East. Similarly, China has often worried about Russia’s imperial behavior. So, China has been cautious in dealing with Russia and not turning their friendship into any new alliance. And Russia never allows China to play a more significant economic role and push China’s currency as an exchange in the BRICS transaction (Stunkel 2015; Larionova 2012). At the same time, China’s increasing foothold in Russia’s strategic areas like Central Area and its military base in Tajikistan in 2016 may cause a rift between China and Russia in advancing the joint BRICS project. That is why the BRICS is still not fruitful in bringing their currency to replace the dollar's role in the global economy.

Global Governance

China and Russia have divergent views on the UN Security Council reforms because China’s interest arguably lies more on a bipolar rather than genuinely multipolar world order and the global economic effects of China’s currency (Cooper 2013). The rivalry between Russia and China over BRICS’ status was that Russia wanted BRICS to be a more powerful political group in present-day world affairs. On the other hand, China never regarded BRICS as a challenge to the world order because it will create a rivalry between China and the United States. China does not want this. It is an open secret that the United States never wanted BRICS to become more assertive and have China assume more responsibilities. However, the United States was alright with the Chinese global role. Somewhere, Russia did not accept the rising Chinese influence in the group either (Lye and Zhang 2010). Further, Scholar Lo (2014) very candidly said: